

Renee Ziqi ZHU

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[Google Scholar](#) | [Academic Website](#)

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RESEARCH FOCUS

Human-AI Interaction; AI Companionship Configuration; Wellbeing Sustainability; Critical Design; Feminist HCI

EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy (Ph.D.) 2025–2029 (expected)

Indiana University Bloomington

Luddy School of Informatics, Computing, and Engineering

- **Major:** Informatics, HCI track
- **Advisor:** Eli Blevis
- Fall 2025 Luddy Doctoral Associate Instructor Fellowship
- Luddy Doctoral Summer Fellowship

Master of Science (M.S.) 2023–2025

Indiana University Bloomington

Luddy School of Informatics, Computing, and Engineering

- **Major:** Human-Computer Interaction Design

Bachelor of Architecture 2018–2023

Huazhong University of Science and Technology

School of Architecture and Urban Design

- **Major:** Architecture

PUBLICATIONS

Published paper

1. **Renee Ziqi Zhu**, Nan Hu, Lihao Zheng, and Xinyun Zhang. 2026. MERRY: A Community-Based Robot for Enhancing Social Connection of Older Adults. In *Companion Proceedings of the 21st ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction (HRI Companion '26)*. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 1189–1192. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3776734.3794591>

Under review

1. **Renee Ziqi Zhu**, Xinyun Zhang, and Susan C. Herring. Choreographing Power Play: 3 Levels of Power Dynamics in AI BDSM Roleplay. Under review at the *2027 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '27)*.
2. Xinyun Zhang, **Renee Ziqi Zhu**, and Susan C. Herring. The Position More Than the Speaker: Enacted Power and (Im)politeness in Human-AI BDSM Roleplay. Under review at the *2027 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '27)*.

Working

1. **Renee Ziqi Zhu**, Nan Hu, and Selma Sabanovic. The Flexible Role of Prototypes in Participatory Design Research: Rethinking Methodological Practices through Robot Design Workshops with Older Adults. Targeting the *ACM Designing Interactive Systems Conference 2027 (DIS '27)*.
2. **Renee Ziqi Zhu**, Zitao Zhang, Lingyun Chen, Ruixiang Han, and Eli Blevis. Blooming-Path: A Metaphorical Installation Making Social Clock Tangible. Targeting the Pictorials track of the *21st ACM International Conference on Tangible, Embedded and Embodied Interaction (TEI '27)*.

OTHER PROJECTS

1. Muwu Shan, Lingyun Chen, **Ziqi Zhu**, Zitao Zhang, Chen Ling, and Eli Blevis. 2025. Navigating Authenticity of Visual Forms in the Digital Age. Workshop accepted and held at *iConference 2025*.
2. **Locus: AR Application That Helps Young Adults with ADHD** (Individual)
 - Finalist, 1st Don Norman Design Award; finalist, Luddy Cheng Wu Competition 2024.
 - Showcased at the DNDA Summit, November 2024.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Indiana University Bloomington

Bloomington, IN, USA

Associate Instructor

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| • I542 Foundation of HCI | Fall 2024 |
| • I609/709 Seminar in HCI | Spring 2025 |
| • I300 Human-Computer Interaction/Design | Spring 2026 |
| • I300 Human-Computer Interaction/Design | Fall 2026 |

PROFESSIONAL SERVICES

Reviewer

- | | |
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| • Creativity & Cognition 2026 Pictorials | March 18, 2026 |
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PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS AND SOCIETIES

Association for Computing Machinery (ACM), Student Member

PROFESSIONAL REFERENCES

1. **Eli Blevis, Ph.D. (Committee Chair)**
Professor of Informatics
Department of Informatics
Luddy School of Informatics, Computing, and Engineering
Indiana University Bloomington
E-mail: eblevis@iu.edu
2. **Selma Sabanovic, Ph.D. (Committee Member)**
Professor of Informatics and Cognitive Science
Department of Informatics
Luddy School of Informatics, Computing, and Engineering
Indiana University Bloomington

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3. Elizabeth Kaziunas, Ph.D. (Committee Member)

Assistant Professor of Informatics

Department of Informatics

Luddy School of Informatics, Computing, and Engineering

Indiana University Bloomington

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4. Antino Kim, Ph.D. (Minor Advisor)

Associate Professor

Department of Operations & Decision Technologies

Kelley School of Business

Indiana University Bloomington

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